

Experimental Handbook

Purpose

Operationalize the Version 1.0 contracts without changing theory. Every study must declare the interaction boundary, participants, task, projection, opportunity structure, observation model, behavior coding, measures, uncertainty, and falsification conditions.

Required workflow

Register the target construct and canonical identifier.

Instantiate the relevant contract.

Define population, task, context, initial state, projection, authority, and timescale.

Separate raw records, detected events, attributed behavior, latent constructs, and conclusions.

Predeclare exclusions, missing-data handling, manipulation checks, and comparison tolerances.

Capture provenance and software/instrument versions.

Report uncertainty and alternative explanations.

Protocol families

Interaction

Declare systems, coupling, reciprocal or recurrent closure, boundaries, initiation, transitions, completion, failure, and recovery.

Behavior

Specify observation model, segmentation, attribution criteria, trace representation, and prohibition on inferring intention from action alone.

Opportunity

Record possible, capable, permitted, enabled, reachable, exposed, signaled, believed, selected, executed, successful, and reversible dimensions separately.

Similarity and comparison

Declare correspondence, observables, invariants, transformations, metric, tolerance, uncertainty, and incomparability conditions.

Transfer and strategy

Use source-target controls. Treat strategy as latent and require evidence across contingencies.

Prediction

Declare target, horizon, information set, population, regime, calibration, uncertainty, and observation-versus-intervention status.

Minimum reporting

Research question; preregistration; canonical constructs; contracts; sample; apparatus; task; records; coding; measures; models; uncertainty; results; robustness; exclusions; limitations; falsification outcome; data and code availability.